



GTA VI in Vice City?

Clues on a website within GTA 5 suggest that the next location for GTA might be Vice City. <https://dgit.in/jun20-11>



Netflix acquire Egyptian theatre

Netflix has acquired Hollywood's historic Egyptian theatre to premiere their movies. <https://dgit.in/jun20-12>

FEATURE

BHIMBETKA ROCK SHELTERS

The Bhimbetka rock shelters in Madhya Pradesh are a UNESCO world heritage site, and have evidence of the oldest human life in the Indian subcontinent. This is an active archaeological dig, and is surprisingly accessible to the general public. The best thing about the complex are the rock paintings, some of which may be as many as 10,000 years old. The site has been occupied multiple times throughout history, so there are paintings from many different time periods. The paintings are intricate and well preserved, depicting scenes of hunting, dancing, tribal warfare and trade. Then there are a number of animals including bison, tigers, rhinos, elephants, peacocks, deer and snakes.

CHAND BAORI

Chand Baori or Chand Bawdi is a stepwell built in the 9th century by King Chanda, and can be found near the Abhaneri village in Rajasthan. The well is no longer in use. Instead of just a series of steps though, there are a number of tiny narrow staircases symmetrically arranged on three sides of the well. The 3,500 steps are arranged in a criss cross pattern. The fourth side has windows, known as jharokha, which allows for an enclosed area that still has access to the water. The rooms beyond the windows have many ancient sculptures. This is India's largest and deepest stepwell and has 13 levels.

GARGOTI MINERAL MUSEUM

From fossilised tree trunks to geodes cut open, this museum near Nashik has a spectacular collection of geological curiosities from the Deccan plateau. It is the only gem and mineral museum in India, and also the whole collection is privately owned. Many of the items in the collection can be viewed in an online gallery, which should be enough to convince you to go and check out the museum in person. The corals and the zeolite crystals are simply exquisite. Then there are the fossils, which include actual real dinosaur eggs, ginormous ammonites, and ancient crustaceans. The best thing is though, the museum actually has a piece of



One of the exhibits at the Gargoti mineral museum

Credit: Gargoti Museum

moon rock, and a martian rock as well. You can also see large nuggets of gold in their natural shape.

GASS FOREST MUSEUM

At Coimbatore is one of the most enchanting natural history museums you can possibly see. It is not just the collections, but how they are presented as well. There are giant cases with taxidermied beasts. A pair of huge elephant tusks is at the entrance, with a portrait of Gandhi stretched between them. You can see skeletons of marine mammals. In one corner is an entire mounted human skeleton, a bison skeleton, and a puny human skeleton between them for comparison. Then there are the creatures preserved in formaldehyde, which includes elephant embryos in various stages of development. This one is unmissable if you want to see the wildlife of India inside out.

GD NAIDU CAR MUSEUM

This one is in Coimbatore too, which means you can strike off two items from the bucket list. Sure, there are a bunch of cars from all over the world including Germany, Japan and Italy, but what we really liked are the information on all the walls that inform you much more about the exhibits. The charm is really in the vintage and classic cars that are on display, many of them painstakingly restored. You just might find an odd motorcycle too. There is a Benz Motorwagen from 1886, and a Model T Ford as well.

JANTAR MANTAR

While the most famous Jantar Mantar is in Jaipur, there are actually 5 of these ancient observatories, with the other ones in Varanasi, Mathura, Ujjain and New Delhi, all of which were built by Maharaja Jai Singh II. It makes sense to add all of them to your bucket list, but the one we like the most is the one in Ujjain. The astronomical structures are white, which is in line with modern observatories, and is a most photogenic state of disrepair. The location is important as the Jantar Mantar is located where the prime meridian in the Indian tradition intersects with the Tropic of Cancer.

JIM CORBETT MUSEUM

Located at Kaladhungi in Nainital, is the bungalow of the conservationist that has been converted to the museum. Corbett was also a very efficient railway officer, who took care of his people, and the love that the Indians had for him is shown to this day with his bust being covered with garlands of flowers. The museum houses rare pictures of Corbett, as well as the guns that he used to take down man eaters, and a variety of stuffed animals. Not all of these are trophies, one of the many stuffed tigers on display was killed when an elephant pushed over a tree trunk! There are also more mundane objects such as the beds, tables and furniture used by Corbett. A visit to the museum is a must for anyone who enjoyed reading his books.

JOLLY BUOY ISLAND

This is one of the Andaman and Nicobar islands that it is actually recommended to visit. This place is so absolutely gorgeous that even the locals cannot have enough of it, and there is a crowd for the tickets even in such an isolated location. Half the fun is in the boat ride over, where beautiful corals and tropical marine life can be seen through the crystal clear waters. The boats have glass bottoms for a better experience.

LAITLUM GRAND CANYON

Once you make this trek in Meghalaya, your whole idea of what a canyon is